INSIDE STUDIO SP · VST3

MASTER DOS MAGOS

MASTERING WIZARD

Step-by-step manual

Version 0.2.0 · Windows and macOS · VST3 and AU



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What MASTER DOS MAGOS is

MASTER DOS MAGOS is a "one-click" mastering plugin. It goes **last on the master**, listens to the drop of your track (and, if you want, a reference track) and, with the `CAST` button, builds a complete mastering chain:

- **TONE MATCH**: matches the frequency balance to the reference or to the STYLE curve (9 bands, up to ±6 dB).
- **DYNAMIC EQ**: cuts MUD (240 Hz), HARSH (3.3 kHz) and DE-ESS (7.5 kHz) only on peaks, and boosts LOW PUNCH (63 Hz) and AIR (12.5 kHz) only when they're missing.
- **MULTIBAND COMP**: 4-band compressor (crossovers at 120 Hz, 1.2 kHz and 6.5 kHz), with automatic threshold.
- **MONO low end** below 120 Hz.
- **True peak limiter** with a −0.3 dBTP ceiling, taking the track to the loudness **TARGET**.

Everything is **linear phase**: the kick transient comes through intact and the bands sum back perfectly. You can still dial it all in with 5 knobs and, if you want, take manual control of the compressor and the DYNAMIC EQ.

Before you start

ITEM	DETAILS
Format	VST3 and AU, Windows and macOS. Mono or stereo input.
Where it goes	On the **master**, as the **last** plugin in the chain.
Latency	About 55 ms (2640 samples at 48 kHz). The DAW compensates automatically. You only notice it when playing or recording live through the master.
Paired with MAESTRO	With MAESTRO on the 8 groups of the same project, MAGOS shows which group each problem comes from (see page 8).

Installation and activation

1. Download the installer from the link in your purchase e-mail and choose Windows or Mac.
2. Run the installer and open your DAW (if needed, have it scan for new plugins).
3. The first time, enter your **purchase e-mail** and the **token** (ISP-XXXX-…) that came with it.

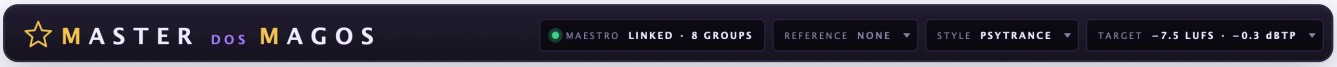
LICENSE. The token works on up to 2 computers. To switch machines, deactivate it on the old computer and the slot is freed up. Internet is only needed for activation; after that the license re-checks itself every 45 days. To see the license: click the `MASTER DOS MAGOS` logo › `License…`.

WITHOUT ACTIVATION, the plugin opens but passes audio straight through, unprocessed (with the same latency, so your project stays aligned).

STEP 1

1 Put it last on the master

Insert MASTER DOS MAGOS on the master channel, **after all other plugins**. It has the final limiter, so nothing should come after it.



Top of the window: MAESTRO (link), REFERENCE, STYLE and TARGET.

STEP 2

2 Pick the target: REFERENCE or STYLE

With a reference: drag a reference track (WAV, AIFF, FLAC, OGG or MP3) onto the plugin window, or click `REFERENCE ▼` › *Load a reference…*. MAGOS then aims for its tone and loudness.

Without a reference: the target is the `STYLE ▼` curve:

STYLE	STYLE LOUDNESS	STYLE	STYLE LOUDNESS
PSYTRANCE	−7.5 LUFS	**HOUSE**	−8.0 LUFS
PROG PSY	−8.5 LUFS	**DRUM & BASS**	−7.0 LUFS
TECHNO	−8.0 LUFS	**POP**	−9.0 LUFS

With a reference loaded, two switches at the bottom decide what to copy from it: `MATCH TONE TO REFERENCE` (tone) and `MATCH LOUDNESS TO REFERENCE` (level). Both are on by default. To go back to the STYLE curve: `REFERENCE ▼` › *Remove the reference*.

STEP 3

3 Check the TARGET

Click `TARGET ▼`. The default is **AUTO**: the reference's loudness or, without one, the STYLE's. You can also set a fixed value: −14 LUFS (streaming-safe), −11, −9, −8, −7 (loud club), −6 (very loud) or −5 (extreme). The ceiling is always −0.3 dBTP (true peak).

> **IMPORTANT.** A new STYLE or TARGET only takes effect on the **next CAST**.

STEP 4

4 LISTEN: let it hear the drop

1. Set the playhead to the loudest part of the track (the **drop**).
2. Click `LISTEN` (ANALYZE TRACK + REF). The button turns orange and shows the time: `LISTENING · 0:12`.
3. Hit play and let it run for **20 to 30 seconds**.



Bottom bar: LISTEN, CAST, the 5 knobs, the reference switches and A / B / REF / BYPASS.

STEP 5

5 CAST: the master in one click

After the 20–30 s, click `✦ CAST ✦` (ONE CLICK MASTER). It shows `CASTING… 5 s` while it builds the chain:

- matches the tone (TONE MATCH);
- sets up the 4-band compressor based on what it heard;
- turns on the DYNAMIC EQ;
- drives the limiter to the TARGET.

During the first ~20 s the level settles on its own. If the limiter would need to take off **more than 5 dB** to reach the target, it stops short and warns you (`TARGET TOO LOUD FOR THIS MIX`): a sign that the mix needs less level or more work at the source.

After the CAST, the button shows `CAST · CLICK TO RECAST`. Changed the track, the reference, the STYLE or the TARGET? Do LISTEN and CAST again.

> **CAST WITHOUT LISTEN?** The plugin warns you: "Press LISTEN first and play the loudest part of your track (the drop) for 20–30 s. Then CAST."

> **START OVER.** Logo › `Reset (clear the CAST)` clears the CAST.

STEP 6

6 Compare: A / B / REF / BYPASS

BUTTON	WHAT YOU HEAR
A	The MAGOS master.
B	Your original mix, **at the same loudness** as the master (so "louder" doesn't fool your ears).
REF ›	The reference track, also at the same loudness.
BYPASS	The original mix, untouched.

LOUDER ≠ BETTER. Streaming platforms turn the volume down anyway. That's why A/B is always at the same loudness.

STEP 7

7 Dial it in with the 5 knobs

KNOB	RANGE / DEFAULT	WHAT IT DOES
AMOUNT	0–100% · **72%**	Intensity of everything the CAST does.
CHARACTER	0–100% · **30%**	From clean to warm: shows CLEAN (below 20%), CLEAN · WARM or WARM (above 70%).
PUNCH	−5 to +5 · **0.0**	Compressor attack: slower = more transient (more "punch").
WIDTH	0–200% · **100%**	Stereo width of the upper bands. The low end stays MONO below 120 Hz.
TONE TILT	−3 to +3 dB · **0.0**	Tilts the tone: darker (−) or brighter (+).

How to use the knobs

- **Drag** up and down; hold **Shift** for fine adjustment.
- **Double-click** returns to the default; the **mouse wheel** also adjusts.

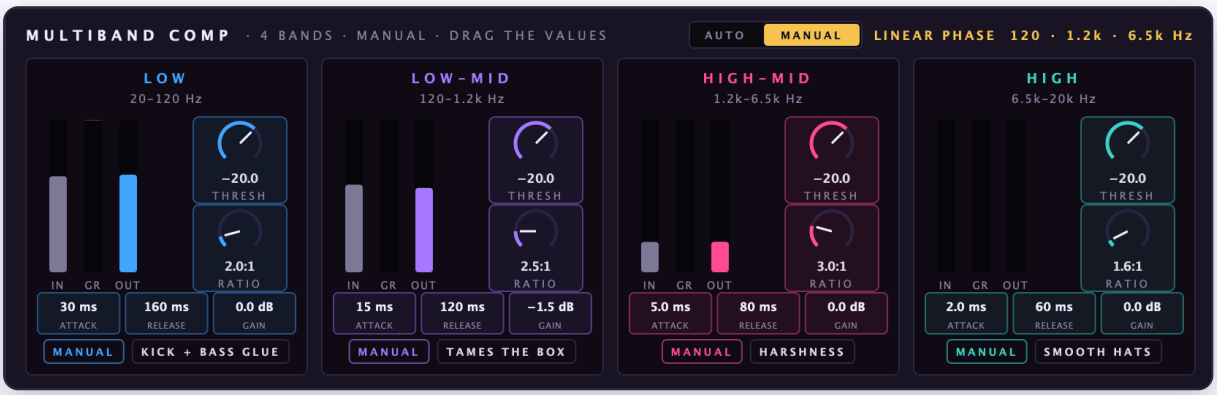
MONO LOW END. "Bass mono < 120 Hz" is on by default and is a DAW parameter (you can automate it). When it's on, the `BASS MONO < 120 Hz` badge shows up in LOUDNESS.

STEP 8

8 Fine-tuning in MANUAL (optional)

The MULTIBAND COMP and the DYNAMIC EQ run in **AUTO**. To take control, click `MANUAL` on the panel. Manual mode starts from what AUTO was doing, so the sound doesn't jump. The framed values become adjustable: **drag up or down** (Shift = fine, double-click = default, mouse wheel also works). `AUTO` goes back to automatic.

MULTIBAND COMP · 4 bands



LOW (KICK + BASS GLUE), LOW-MID (TAMES THE BOX), HIGH-MID (HARSHNESS) and HIGH (SMOOTH HATS), in MANUAL.

VALUE	RANGE	WHAT IT DOES
THRESH	−60 to 0 dB	Level above which the band compresses.
RATIO	1:1 to 20:1	How much it compresses.
ATTACK	0.1 to 300 ms	How fast it starts compressing.
RELEASE	5 to 3000 ms	How fast it lets go.
GAIN	−12 to +12 dB	Band level after compression.

DYNAMIC EQ · 5 points



- **Click the name** of the point (LOW PUNCH, MUD, HARSH, DE-ESS, AIR) to turn it on or off.
- **MAX CUT** (MUD, HARSH, DE-ESS) or **MAX LIFT** (LOW PUNCH, AIR): 0 to 8 dB, the most the point can cut or boost.
- **THRESH**: 0 to 12 dB, how far the sound must be off target before the point kicks in.

AUTOMATION. Everything in MANUAL is saved with the project and can be automated in the DAW.

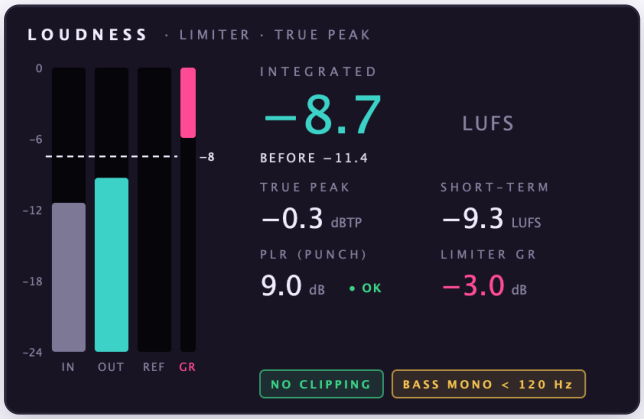
Reading the screen

TONAL BALANCE



- **BEFORE** (gray): the mix before. **AFTER** (cyan): after MAGOS.
- **STYLE** or **REFERENCE** (yellow dashed) and the **TARGET ZONE** around it: where the spectrum should sit.
- **DYN EQ** (pink): the DYNAMIC EQ points; the DYNAMIC EQ · LIVE row below shows how much each one is working right now.
- **MATCH 79% · was 64%**: how close the result is to the target, after and before.

LOUDNESS · LIMITER · TRUE PEAK



- **INTEGRATED**: the track's loudness (LUFS), with BEFORE and the REFERENCE's.
- **TRUE PEAK**, **SHORT-TERM** and **LIMITER GR** (how much the limiter is taking off).
- **PLR (PUNCH)**: distance between peak and loudness. **OK** or **SQUASHED**.
- Badges: **NO CLIPPING** / **CLIPPED**, **BASS MONO < 120 Hz** and **TARGET TOO LOUD FOR THIS MIX**.



STEREO

Stereo width of each band (LOW, LOW-MID, HIGH-MID, HIGH) and the **CORRELATION**: **MONO-SAFE**, **WIDE** or **PHASE!** (risk of parts disappearing in mono).

WHERE IT WILL PLAY

How much Spotify, YouTube (−14 LUFS), Apple Music (−16 LUFS) and Beatport / club will turn your track down, and how much low end a **PHONE SPEAKER** loses.

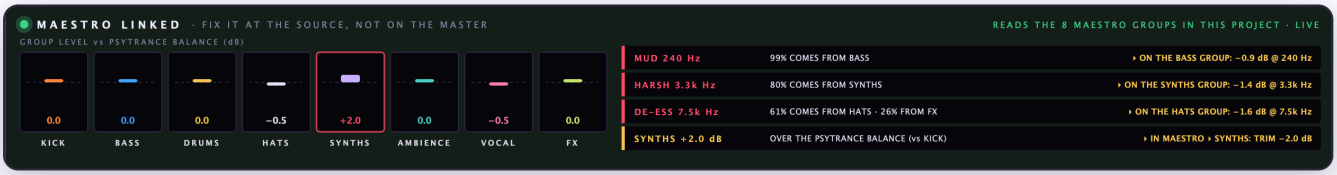
HEAR IT ON

`PHONE` `EARBUDS` `CAR` `MONO`: simulate where the track will be played, for listening only.

> **BEFORE EXPORTING**, turn off HEAR IT ON. While it's on, the warning `MONITOR SIMULATION ON · TURN OFF BEFORE EXPORT` is shown.

MAESTRO LINKED

If **MAESTRO** is on the 8 groups of the same project, MAGOS links to it on its own: the top shows `MAESTRO LINKED · 8 GROUPS` and the panel below appears. The idea is to **fix it at the source, not on the master** (FIX IT AT THE SOURCE, NOT ON THE MASTER).



- **On the left**: each group's level (KICK, BASS, DRUMS, HATS, SYNTHS, AMBIENCE, VOCAL, FX) against MAESTRO's STYLE balance, in dB.
- **On the right**: each problem on the master, which group it comes from and what to do. E.g. *MUD 240 Hz · 99% COMES FROM BASS › ON THE BASS GROUP: −0.9 dB @ 240 Hz*, or *SYNTHS +2.0 dB › IN MAESTRO › SYNTHS: TRIM −2.0 dB*.
- With no problems, it shows **ALL CLEAR**. With no MAESTRO in the project, MAGOS fixes things on its own on the master (via the DYNAMIC EQ).

> **BUNDLE.** MAESTRO + MASTER DOS MAGOS are sold together on the website. Nothing to set up: the link is automatic and MAESTRO's sound doesn't change.

FAQ and troubleshooting

SITUATION	WHAT TO DO
CAST does nothing / asks for LISTEN	Click LISTEN and play the drop for 20–30 s before CAST.
The sound didn't change	Check that you're on **A** (not B, REF or BYPASS), that you've done the CAST and that the license is active (logo › License…).
TARGET TOO LOUD FOR THIS MIX shows up	The limiter would have to take off more than 5 dB. Pick a lower TARGET or adjust the mix (MAESTRO LINKED shows where the problem comes from).
It's overdone	Lower the AMOUNT. For something specific, use MANUAL on the band or on the DYNAMIC EQ point.
Lacking "punch" / PLR SQUASHED	Turn up PUNCH or pick a lower TARGET.
I changed STYLE or TARGET and nothing changed	They only take effect on the next CAST. Do LISTEN and CAST again.
REF doesn't play	The reference file was moved ("File not found"). Load it again from REFERENCE ▼.
Delay when playing live	That's the ~55 ms latency (linear phase + limiter). Turn the plugin off while recording through the master.
My export sounds like a phone	HEAR IT ON was on. Turn it off and export again.
MAESTRO NOT LINKED	MAESTRO isn't in the same project, or the DAW isolates plugins (e.g. Bitwig with sandbox).

30-second summary

1. MAGOS **last** on the master.
2. Drag in a **reference** or choose the **STYLE**; check the **TARGET**.
3. **LISTEN** + play the drop for 20–30 s → **CAST**.
4. Compare with **A / B / REF** (same loudness).
5. Dial in with AMOUNT, CHARACTER, PUNCH, WIDTH and TONE TILT.
6. If you want, fine-tune in **MANUAL**.
7. Turn off HEAR IT ON and export.

SUPPORT. Questions, suggestions or problems: **contato@insidestudiosp.com.br** · **insidestudiosp.com.br**